The Constitution has been working for about fifteen months. It was incumbent upon the Prime Minister to point out in his speech what exactly have been the difficulties which have compelled the Government to come forward with the proposed changes. To my mind, the explanation which he gave was weak and halting and not acceptable, nor was it satisfactory.

He has assured the House and the country, to quote his own words, that he has not brought forward this measure in a spirit of light-heartedness, not in haste, that he has bestowed careful thought and scrutiny not he, but the Government also; and that they have consulted various people throughout the country. I accept these assertions. But, surely, any changes in the Constitution which may be considered by Parliament have to be considered not in secrecy by the Government along with certain chosen people; but opinion has to be called for on the provisions of the Bill from the people at large, by all sections of public opinion outside the House. I ask the Prime Minister what steps he proposed to take to secure public opinion on the changes that he proposes to make. We have suggested, some of us, that the Bill should be circulated for eliciting public opinion. It has not been suggested as a dilatory motion, because the date within which opinion has to be received varies from 31st May to 15th of July. It is not a formal proposal also. The Prime Minister said that there is no particular hurry about the matter. He made the strange declaration that this Government has no desire to pass any laws on the lines of the changes which he proposes to make and that these are only enabling powers which he wishes to hand over to Parliament or the State Legislatures; that he is making these changes not for the purpose of securing better administration so long as he is the Prime Minister of this country, but that he is thinking more in terms of future Parliaments and the welfare of generations yet to be born. If that is his magnanimity, if that is his great foresight and statesmanship when he tries to peep into the future and read the minds of the people that are yet to come in the sphere of Parliamentary politics, why should he not accept the proposal for circulating the Bill for eliciting public opinion? The changes proposed are not simple. The changes are fundamental and they go to the very root of some of the vital provisions of the Constitution, not only the